

V3.6 FOREST

V3.6 FOREST — the moonshot, whole

V2.0 stopped at the first car. That's a tree. This is the forest — the whole shot, start to finish, in the voice you'd use at the kitchen table. V3.1 and V3.2 add the trees you pinned on 09-21, each set where it grows — and V3.2 fixes what "on a wire" means, in your words. The plan pages (V2.0 JOSHUA, V4.0 PUNCH LIST) are how you take the first step. This page is why the step is worth taking.

Where it starts

1. A newspaper in Spanish Fork. James Warner came from England; his son Elisha printed the town's paper and wrote a book about it, *A Country Printer*. Elisha's daughter Evelyn married Ray Loveless and they built a cabin at Strawberry. Their daughter is your mother. You're the third face in a five-generation photograph, and the two books that started you — the printer's and Cousteau's — both came through that cabin on a Christmas morning.
2. Twenty years as a police commander. The one rule under all of it: decide *before* the emergency who gets saved first — victims, then the public, then the officers, then the person causing it. Order chosen ahead of the moment, so the moment doesn't choose it. Every system you've built since has that shape.
3. Then a rebuild — a degree, a teaching licence, software, product. At work they asked you to check twice as many calls; you checked all of them, and let the machine put the ones that need a human on top. The machine never grades a person. That's the method. It's written down, copyrighted, and it's yours wherever you go.

The gap

4. One night you stood at a bar door with no ride home, and the last ten yards between you and safe didn't exist. That's the gap. It isn't a Salt Lake problem or a drinking problem; it's the last ten yards between *any* service and *any* person — the ride that isn't there, the medicine that stops at the pharmacy counter, the bed that's full, the desk a child can't reach. It's widest in the mountain West, where the distances are longest and the towns are smallest.
5. You can't drive across that gap until 2033. You can own the thing that closes it, starting now.

The first step — one car, and the state counting

6. One car, reliably at a bar door at closing time, in the county where two-thirds of Utah's drunk-driving arrests happen. Salt Lake County had 380 of those crashes in 2024; 145 of them were in the five hours around closing. The rider doesn't pay — the state and the bars do, because fewer crashes is their money and their lives. So before the car moves, the state signs one page saying how it will measure whether this worked. Andrea's \$50,000 is that car and its first ninety nights, on a note, with a brake. Ninety nights. One number on the state's letterhead.

6a — the ride instead of the sentence. Today a DUI costs a man an ignition interlock he rents by the month, a stack of fines and fees, and jail nights — and none of it puts a car at the door the next Friday. The state already has one alternative on its books, the 24/7 Sobriety program: test twice a day instead of losing your licence. The next one is simpler: **the ride you buy replaces the interlock you rent, the fines you pay, and the nights you sit.** A court sentences a man to a year of being driven home. The car logs it. The state gets the number. That's a bill to write, not a product to invent — and the ninety nights are its evidence.

What the number unlocks

7. **A fleet that works twenty hours, not four.** The same car that's at a bar door at 1 a.m. is at a dialysis door at 8 a.m. and a farmhouse with a prescription at noon. Utah's over-65 population goes from one in eight to one in four; every one of them has a ride problem and a medicine problem. Night pays for the car; day pays for the company.

7a — the van is a class, not a vehicle. Call it the cybervan. One chassis, every load that ever needed a van: the non-emergency ambulance run (the licensed one when the law lets a machine carry a patient), the same-day parcel, the mail, the food truck that parks where lunch is, the door and the window and the finish carpentry, the lumber to the job site — and everything else that's a van today and nobody has listed yet. Medicine is the anchor load because it's the one the state pays to measure; the rest ride on the same network afterward. Amazon's van, the Postal Service's van, the food truck and the lumber yard's flatbed are one class, and a class is what a fleet takes, one load at a time.

7b — the public-safety class. Fire trucks, police vehicles, the armored ones (Bearcats), and Lifeflight — call the air-ambulance line RoboLife — on three chassis: the Semi for fire and heavy, the cybervan for medical and transport, the SUV for patrol. This is the fleet you ran for twenty years, on the rule you ran it by: victims, public, officers, subject, in that order, decided before the call. The machine sequences the response; the responder is the human at the end. The agencies that buy these are the same offices that fund the first car — the state's public-safety money already lists "police vehicles" as an allowed use in the rural program.

7c — the golf cart, not the Jazzy. For the old, the last ten yards happen at walking speed: from the door to the car, from the lot to the clinic, down the hall of the care home. A golf cart — open, shared, summoned — instead of the mobility scooter each person has to buy and park and charge. The fleet's smallest vehicle, and the one that touches the most people.

8. **A depot that powers itself.** A building with a roof of solar and a battery in the garage, where the cars come home to their own electricity — a gas station where the return trip is free. The yardstick for every bay: what it returns per night. The first depot is the Midvale complex if the city says yes; if not, any garage — the depot is an idea, not an address.
9. **Beds, not just rides.** The first tenant in that building is a medical detox facility, run by someone who already holds the licence and a county contract. The man the car picks up at closing is the man the courts send to a bed; the car that took him home is the car that brings him to it and the car that brings him back. Ride, bed, ride — one pipeline, measured end to end. Utah lost 617 people to overdoses in 2024. The county says out loud it doesn't have enough beds.
10. **Medicine, the last mile and the last ten yards.** Utah law already lets a small "branch pharmacy" live in a rural town, stocked and supervised by a full pharmacy somewhere else. A truck is the backbone, a van is the last mile, and the last ten yards — the curb to the kitchen table — is a person today and a machine when the machine is ready. *Pharmadash*: medicine is the load that justifies the network; everything else rides on it afterward.

The footprint

11. **Wendover, then the corridors.** The second site is the small town at the end of the salt flats — 1,115 people, the kind of place the federal rural program was written for. Then the four corridors driven at 1 a.m. with two phones and a dish on the roof, logging every thirty seconds where the signal dies. The map of dead miles is the requirements document for every state after this one.

11a — employee #1. The first hire isn't a founder and isn't family. It's the person the network was built to serve: a working stylist who already knows the easy version, who wants to be a nurse, whose trade is repeat trust with a chair — the same thing as a car reliably at a door — and who is building security from small regular amounts, which is the discipline the ninety-night log needs. Night lead, dispatcher, the human at the end of every trip, and the first person who could open Wendover. She hasn't been asked. Her name is on the pinboard, first name only.

11b — the backbone: two lines that cross. Under the corridors, a hyperloop — a fixed high-speed line, whatever it's

built as — on two cardinals that cross at Salt Lake: north-south from Logan to Saratoga Springs, the whole Wasatch Front in one line; east-west from Stansbury Park to Heber, Tooele County to Wasatch County across the city. The cars and vans are the last ten yards at both ends of it; the line is the middle. The ordinals — the diagonals — come after the cardinals, the way the second county comes after the first. Nothing on any page with a dollar on it; on the map so the fleet is drawn to feed it.

12. **Ten states.** Washington, Oregon, Montana, Idaho, Wyoming, Colorado, Utah, Nevada, New Mexico, Arizona.

Every one of them has the same federal drunk-driving money flowing through the same kind of state office, the same rural program, the same distances and the same thin pharmacies. Utah's signed page and Utah's number are the key that fits all ten doors. That's not ten businesses. It's one business, proven once, walked to ten offices.

12a — the true moon shots. Past the ten western states are six that aren't the same door: Texas, California, Florida, Illinois, New York, Massachusetts. Big, dense, already served, already regulated — the places where a ride is never *absent*, only unreliable, expensive, or owned by someone else. Two of them, Texas and Florida, are where unsupervised robotaxis already run today. These six aren't proven by Utah's number; they're proven by ten states' numbers. They're on the page so nobody mistakes the ten for the ceiling; the West is the proof; these are the prize.

13. **Own the fleet and the load.** Uber and Lyft sell seats and own nothing — no cars, no cargo, no destination. We own the cars, the building the cars come home to, the beds inside it, and the medicine in the back seat. The ride companies fight over pennies at the curb forever; the company that owns where the ride goes doesn't. That's the takeover: not their app, their *margin*, by being reliably there and owning the other end.

14. **The Tesla stack.** Robotaxi for the doors; Robovan for the wheelchair and the group from the care home; Semi for the backbone; solar roof and batteries for the depot; the robot for the bedside when it's ready. Utah already allows self-driving cars on its roads by law. The fleet is driven by people until the day it isn't, and the day it isn't, the cost per night falls off a cliff and the footprint stops being limited by drivers.

14a — the ladder up, and what "on a wire" means. Not a Jetsons car. A VTOL that a person summons with an app, the way they'd summon a Robotaxi, and that flies itself safely from home to work and back — the app draws the path, the craft follows it, the rider does nothing. "On a wire" is that path. It's a Lyft or Uber substitute for everyday workers, priced like a ride, not like an aircraft. Your boss's commute is two hours; on a wire it's ten minutes. The **ironman backpack** is the same model for one person — summoned, navigated, a commute — the business-class seat of the same ladder. Taxi on the road, van for the load, VTOL for the commute, backpack for one. Same rule at every rung: a fixed path, a machine that follows it, a person at the end. The bottom rungs are real today; the top rungs are certified the day the regulator says so, and the app is already waiting for them.

14b — the mountain. A VTOL for skiers and snowboarders instead of a tram: a lift with no cable, no towers, no line at the base — summoned, flown to the top, gone. The resort's tram is a wire you can see; this is the wire you can't.

14c — the backpack at work. The backpack isn't the commute for these people; it's the suit. Underwater welders and high-altitude welders work where the environment itself is the punishment — pressure, cold, wind, thin air, the long climb or the long descent before the first bead is laid, and the fatigue that gets people killed at the end of a shift. The backpack carries them to height and to depth, holds them there, and takes the environment off their body so the only thing left is the weld. It doesn't just get a welder to the job; it makes the job possible for a person who couldn't do it otherwise, and it brings them back. That's the last ten yards at its most literal: the ten yards between a person and a place that would kill them without help.

And the kingfisher. The bird hovers, holds, and drops straight through the surface for the fish. A person with the backpack does the same — over the water, still, then down. The scuba instructor flies to the dive. The guide flies to the pool nobody can hike to. You said it yourself: you'd die to go sport fishing like a kingfisher with one. That's the tree with your name on it.

The sky

15. You don't build satellites; you rent the sky that's already there — a dish on every car, a dish on every depot, a \$10 add-on that lets a rider's phone summon a car where there's no tower. You register the depot's own radio in

the shared band, free, first come. You buy the daytime pictures from the constellation that got there first, and you count the nights from the cars themselves. A satellite of your own is the last move, and only when someone has already agreed to buy the data it sees — because the licence, not the rocket, is the long pole, and the metric up there is the same one as in the garage: what comes back per unit sent up.

The moon

16. **The shot:** a fleet across ten western states that closes the last ten yards for anyone who can't reach care on their own — the drunk at the door, the old woman who needs dialysis, the farmhouse that needs its prescription, the man who needs a bed tonight — powered by its own roofs, measured by the states themselves, owned rather than rented, and run by a machine that sorts with a human at the end of every trip. One county proves it. One number unlocks it. Ten states are the same door ten times — and past them, six true moon shots.
17. Andrea's classroom is the same idea at a child's height: a fair rule everyone can see, and a teacher at the end. The desk that comes to the child, the floor with no carpet, the marked path out — the last ten yards at twenty-two inches. Paige is the nurse practitioner on the medicine layer. Richard Allred is the bedrock. The family is what it's for.
18. It ends at Strawberry. The real lake, where your grandparents fished, where the printer's book and the ocean book came through on a Christmas morning. The channel walks the whole thing there, one number a card. The series ends where the family gathers, not where the data lands.

In one sentence: I spent twenty years deciding who gets helped first; I once needed help and it wasn't there; and I'm building a fleet across ten western states that closes that last little gap for anyone who can't reach care on their own — starting with one car at one bar door, and ending at the lake.

What's real tonight and what's the shot: real — the method, the mind, the books, the county's numbers, the state's question waiting, a building with a price, a first step that costs \$415 and one car. The shot — everything from step 7 on, each behind a gate that says exactly what opens it. The gates are on V2.0 JOSHUA. The shot is here, so it never gets cut down to the trees again.